

DAVID C. FIELDS, M.S.

Senior Automation & Infrastructure Engineer

Cloud | DevOps | DevSecOps | Network Automation | Cybersecurity | AI

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior automation and infrastructure engineer with 35+ years of hands-on experience designing, securing, automating, modernizing, and supporting mission-critical technology environments across financial services, state government, federal/DoD, healthcare, critical infrastructure, consulting, and small-business organizations. Deep expertise in Python, Ansible/AWX, Terraform, Azure DevOps, Linux, cloud platforms, network automation, cybersecurity, virtualization, APIs, enterprise operations, and incident response. This combination of infrastructure automation, network engineering, cybersecurity, infrastructure as code, CI/CD, and platform operations provides strong alignment with modern DevSecOps engineering and architecture roles.

Current work includes hands-on IT consulting, infrastructure automation, cybersecurity, Linux and cloud systems, AI-enabled workflows, website and business-systems development, and development of CharterVantage, an AI-enabled multi-tenant SaaS platform for charter transportation operations. Current work also includes technology leadership and automation support for Lake Area Transport Services LLC dba Ohio Party Bus.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Automation & Development: Python, Bash, PowerShell, REST APIs, JSON, YAML, XML, SQL, PostgreSQL, SQLite, Git, GitHub

DevOps, DevSecOps & Infrastructure as Code: Ansible/AWX, Terraform, Azure DevOps, CI/CD, Docker, Kubernetes, security automation, infrastructure policy analysis, automated remediation

Cloud & Platforms: AWS, Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud, Linux, Unix, Windows, macOS, VMware, Hyper-V

Networking: Cisco IOS, Nexus, ACI, routing, switching, LAN/WAN/MAN, MPLS, SD-WAN, VPN, wireless, load balancing

Cybersecurity: Palo Alto, Cisco, Check Point, SonicWall, firewalls, IDS/IPS, SIEM, SOC operations, incident response, IAM, vulnerability management, PCI, HIPAA, FFIEC, SOX

Operations & Tooling: ServiceNow, PagerDuty, Rundeck, SolarWinds, Wireshark, tcpdump, monitoring, observability, ITIL, documentation, vendor coordination

AI & Software Product Development: AI agents, LLMs, workflow automation, prompt design, human-in-the-loop controls, SaaS requirements, testing, documentation, deployment planning

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

PRINCIPAL IT CONSULTANT / INFRASTRUCTURE AUTOMATION ENGINEER

April 2025–Present

Lighthouse Digital Logistix LLC — Hebron / Central Ohio

- Provide hands-on IT consulting, infrastructure support, software development, systems engineering, cybersecurity, website development, and business-process automation for small businesses, individuals, and internally operated companies.

- Design, configure, maintain, and troubleshoot Windows, Linux, macOS, endpoint, network, cloud, SaaS, identity, backup, website, database, API, and business-application environments.
- Develop Python scripts, API integrations, and automated workflows for reporting, notifications, scheduling, customer communications, operational support, and system administration.
- Architect and develop CharterVantage, a multi-tenant SaaS charter-transportation operations platform covering requirements analysis, workflow design, database design, application architecture, integrations, testing, technical documentation, deployment planning, and AI-assisted features.
- Build and evaluate AI-enabled workflows for trip-data extraction, operational analysis, customer communications, dispatch readiness, follow-up, and administrative automation, using human approval gates for customer-facing and financial actions.
- Build and maintain Linux-based AI and automation lab environments using Ubuntu, Docker, Kubernetes, Git/GitHub, Telegram-integrated agents, laptops, Raspberry Pi systems, and local/cloud development tools.
- Diagnose and repair hardware, operating-system, driver, network, account-access, security, and performance problems; provide end-user support, technical assessments, documentation, recommendations, and training.

OWNER / TECHNOLOGY & OPERATIONS DIRECTOR

September 2021–Present

Lake Area Transport Services LLC dba Ohio Party Bus — Hebron, Ohio

- Serve as technology and systems lead for Google Workspace, websites, booking and CRM systems, telematics, electronic logging, mobile devices, computers, user accounts, cybersecurity controls, backups, and cloud applications.
- Design and implement workflows using APIs, Python, Zapier, AI tools, email, forms, databases, and reporting platforms to improve sales, dispatch, pricing, payroll, customer communications, and fleet operations.
- Build policies, operating procedures, dashboards, pricing tools, customer-communication templates, and automation-assisted decision workflows.
- Translate real-world charter operations into product requirements, workflows, test cases, and validation scenarios for CharterVantage.
- Own and operate a seven-vehicle interstate charter transportation company with approximately 30 independent contractors and support personnel, while directing sales, dispatch, finance, compliance, safety, fleet planning, vendor management, and day-to-day operations.

SENIOR AUTOMATION ENGINEER – NETWORK AUTOMATION / CLOUD

DEVOPS

August 2020–September 2024

Huntington National Bank — Columbus, Ohio

- Designed and delivered enterprise-scale automation using Python, Ansible/AWX, Terraform, Git/GitHub, Azure DevOps, ServiceNow, PagerDuty, Rundeck, Docker, and Kubernetes.
- Built automated infrastructure health reporting and remediation workflows supporting executive visibility and 24x7 operations.
- Developed a Palo Alto firewall policy-analysis solution that examined hundreds of thousands of firewall objects and rules in minutes, produced structured reports for disaster-recovery and site-recovery readiness, and replaced extensive manual analysis.
- Automated incident and service workflows across network, security, remote-access, ATM, WAN-circuit, VoIP, proxy, power, and high-bandwidth events; automation accounted for more than half of incoming ticket volume and supported resolution of 10,000+ incidents and requests annually.
- Supported Cisco routers and switches, Nexus, ACI, Palo Alto and Cisco firewalls, F5 load balancers, branch networks, ATMs, remote access, WAN services, and critical financial-services infrastructure.

- Created Python-based data-analysis and decision-support pipelines for large firewall and network datasets in a regulated banking environment.

NETWORK & SECURITY ENGINEER CONSULTANT

February 2018–August 2020

Apex Systems / Huntington National Bank — Columbus, Ohio

- Provided enterprise operations support for network, security, remote-access, branch, and ATM infrastructure.
- Developed Python automations supporting WAN circuits, VoIP, web proxies, vendor coordination, conference bridges, power events, and high-bandwidth incidents.
- Documented incidents, refined support procedures, and contributed to audit and regulatory readiness.

SENIOR NETWORK ENGINEER / LEAD NETWORK ENGINEER

June 2012–November 2017

Alliance Data Systems and Fujitsu America — Columbus, Ohio

- Engineered and supported large-scale regulated LAN, WAN, MPLS, VPN, firewall, NAC, wireless, and multi-datacenter environments across the United States and Canada.
- Led Cisco ISE, Aruba ClearPass, and Forescout NAC evaluations; supported Aruba ClearPass rollout, 802.1X, compliance remediation, WAN migrations, and disaster-recovery testing.
- Worked extensively with Cisco IOS, NX-OS, Nexus, Catalyst, F5, SolarWinds, Wireshark, and related enterprise platforms.
- Served as subject-matter expert for a 500+ device Cisco enterprise supporting financial-services datacenters and call centers.

SENIOR INFRASTRUCTURE ARCHITECT / DIRECTOR OF INFRASTRUCTURE

June 2009–April 2012

CareWorks Technologies — Dublin, Ohio

- Led a managed-services and engineering practice delivering SaaS, IaaS, PaaS, monitoring, hosting, virtualization, storage, networking, and systems-integration services.
- Designed high-availability VMware, storage, load-balancing, VPN, Windows, Linux, SaaS, and IaaS environments for healthcare, government, hospitality, energy, and commercial clients.
- Built centralized monitoring, alerting, help-desk, and managed-services operations; hired, developed, and mentored a team of more than 10 engineers and technicians.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

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| • Plannet Group — Senior Network Architect | • Cisco Systems — Systems Engineer, Military and Enterprise Accounts |
| • Ohio Department of Job and Family Services — Unix Firewall Specialist | • Miami Jacobs College — Cisco CCNP and CCDP Instructor |
| • C-TEC — Cisco Networking Academy CCNA and CompTIA Security+ Instructor | • ACS Defense at Wright-Patterson AFB — Senior Systems Engineer; held Secret clearance |
| • The Longaberger Company — Senior Information Security Analyst | • Electronic Data Systems — Systems Administrator |
| | • Freudenberg Spunweb Company — LAN Administrator |

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Master of Science, Information Security & Assurance — Norwich University

Bachelor of Science, Computer Information Systems — DeVry University

Current Certifications: CompTIA Security+ | ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) | ITIL v3 Foundation

Previously Held / Expired: VMware VCP5-DCV | CISSP | CISM | CISA | CCNP Enterprise | CCDP | CCSE | CCNA
| CCDA

PROFESSIONAL REFERENCES

Multiple professional references available upon request.

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